

THE HOUSE

Written By
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INT. COFFEE SHOP - MORNING

Brilliant morning. Coffee shop similar to a Dunkin Donuts. Mixture of people and kids going to school, etc.

MIKA BOYKO is in line. He is in his early 60s, Ukranian accent. He is annoyed and looks disapprovingly at person in front of him. The customer obviously checks phone while cashier holds out change for purchase.

MIKA

Ahem

CUSTOMER

Oh hey, thanks! Thanks!

Collects change and moves along. Mika places two dollars and one quarter on counter.

MIKA

Hi, ususal.

Mika takes coffee, finds table and sits with two friends. Older, clearly retirees.

FRIEND 1

Hey Mika, how are you doing.

MIKA

OK. Got up early, watched sun rise, and walked here. Traffic ridiculous today. Crazy. People speed like mad right by school.

FRIEND 2

Hey, how did the house go.

MIKA

I knew you would bring up. Knew it was, three months, right?

FRIEND 1

(smiling)

Seems longer than that!

Mika's hands cover and rub face.

MIKA

Is not. Is just three months. Since that St. Patrick's Day nonsense. Heh ... and it has not. It has not!

FRIEND 3

What is the house. What's that?

FRIEND 2

Oh come on ...

Mika holds up both hands as if to say all is ok

MIKA

I will explain. The house. What is the house. OK. The house is my wife's parnets. Wonderful people. You hear stories about mouther-in-law and trouble. She would do anything for you - no trouble at all.

Mika sips coffee

MIKA

She would do anything for us. Her husband, he died back in the 90s. Smoked like you would not believe. The mothe, she died in February.

FRIEND 3

Sorry about that

MIKA

Yeah, yeah. Thanks. So ... we get the house. Nona has one sister. She lives in Austinn and she tells Nona 'You sell the house. Keep the money. I lived in Austin for last 22 years - you took care of mama. You should keep it.' The sister, she got some money from the mother and did not, mind you, need to clean out all the shit from house.

FRIEND 2

You got a house my friend! A house! House partry. Easy money.

Friend 3 says in passing

FRIEND 3

Austin ...

MIKA

Yeah, easy money. And Austin is OK place. Visited my sister-in-law there four or five times. Visted twice in Juyly. Crazy. Hot, hot, hot. Cannot leave house in daytime, could only leave at night. Reminded me of Egypt where people in the summer can only go outside at tnight.

Mika pauses for more coffee

MIKA

Coffee is weak today. Who make this! Ok, so, that is all good. All fine. Sister OK with everything. Wife OK with everything. All we need to do is sell house, get money, move on.

Immediately break

INT. KITCHEN OF AN OLDER TUDOR HOME. MIKA IS INSIDE WITH HIS WIFE NONA. NONA IS IMPECCABLY DRESSED. SHE IS BEAUTIFUL. BOTH SIT AT THE KITCHEN TABLE. FOR SOME REASON NONA IS EATING A SAUSAGE MCMUFFIN.

MIKA

All he have to do is sell the house. Put it on the market. Set a reasonable price, I know what that price is, and we are good.

NONA

I know. I know! we can see the house and then, we can think about a condo in Ft. Lauderdale.

MIKA

I keep telling you - there is no way we can get anything good in Ft. Lauderdale for the price we can get for this house no way -

NONA

(finishing McMuffin)

You keep saying that. But you are not looking hard enough. I see these shows. I see the Beachfront Bargains, they find these things all the time. I will find something, let me look.

MIKA

You can look all you want. All you want. I will not stop you from doing that. Download the app, search Ft. Lauderdale. There is nothing to had for \$200 thousand. Not even close. Its just ... its not even realistic!

NONA

Exactly, because you do not let me look. You are not looking right.

Mika shakes head, exhales, and looks away.

MIKA

Let's just sell this thing first.
Please. Let's do that. Then we can
argue about Ft. Lauderdale.

NONA

Yes, let's talk about the house. I
know exactly what we need to do.

MIKA

Good, good. Consensus. I know too.

NONA

Really, you know what to do. You
have read my mind and know. Really.

MIKA

Yes, I have. I have looked at the
prices. Houses, comprables.

Nona shaiking head

NONA

Comprables.

MIKA

Yes. Yes. We should put a good
price on the house. Go \$240K or
\$245K to start and get offers. Move
it out.

NONA

Really. That is what we should do.

MIKA

Yes. Really.

NONA

(smiling confidently) This is what
we are going to do.

MIKA

No ... no.

NONA

We are going to use Mikey Drogai.

MIKA

No, no. Why. No. Why? Why Mikey?

NONA

Beacuse, he is a real estate agent.
He knows how to sell a house. And
he knows how to get the best price.
And we know his family.

MIKA

Oh great! Great. So you are providing the precise reasons we should not go with Mikey. What if things go wrong.

NONA

What do you mean, wrong?

MIKA

Mikey is not bale to the house, he listens to you and prices it waty to high, and he get exactly no one interested and looking that the house. I know this kid, we know this kid, we know exactly what he is capable of.

NONA

He sold Mideas house. Two weeks. Two weeks and the house was sold. We will have no problems. None.

MIKA

Oh come on. Midra's house was perfect. Perfect. Updated kitchen, huge yard, you could fit three cars in that garage. I could have sold that house. Easy to do. Your parent's house, this house, not easy.

NONA

(Smiling). No. No. This house is perfect. It is great. There will be no problems.

MIKA

It is not great. Not gret. Not not great. Its good, its a good house, yes. But it has problems.

NONA

Like what?

MIKA

Like the fact the kitchen is out of a 1970s Reader's Digest advertisement. Like the fact there are three bathrooms with pink tiles. Pink tiles. Like the fact every square inch of flooring that is not bathroom is carpeting from the 1980s

-

NONA

(Smiling) You can stop now. I do not need to listen to this. This house, this house, is perfect. It will sell. Besides, I have already called Mikey.

MIKA

How? When? Why did you do this and not ask me?

NONA

Uh, because, I do not need your permission. Is my house. I make the decisions.

MIKA

You do not need my permission that is not what I said.

NONA

Sure sounded like it.

MIKA

Not my permission, just my advice.

NONA

There is some difference between the two?

MIKA

Yes, of course. Of course there is. I would have told you 'Mikey, I don't think he is a good choice.' I see realtors online, I think I know which ones are good. We get that flyer from the Spencer woman, she seems like she knows how to sell a house.

NONA

Well (laughing) we meet Mikey tomorrow.

MIKA

When?

NONA

4PM at my parent's house.

MIKA

Opportunity to discuss?

NONA

Nope. Do you want more coffee.

MIKA
Please ... yes.

EXT. MIKA IS OUTSIDE A PLAIN LOOKING HOUSE BUILT IN THE EARLY 1970S. HE LOOKS AT HIS WATCH WHICH READS 4:20. A LARGE 4 DOOR BACK BMW WITH TINTED WINDOWS WHEELS IN. VANTIY PLAT WITH DROGAI2 PULLS IN. MIKEY STEPS OUT. HE IS TALL, CLOSE TO 6'2. HE IS NICE LOOKING AND WEARS GRAY SLACKS WITH TAN TRENCH COAT. HE SETS CUP OF COFFEE ON TOP OF CAR AS HE TAKES OFF SUNGLASSES. HE THEN CONFIDENTLY WALKS TO MIKA, CARRYING AN ATTACHE CASE.

MIKEY
(booming voice) Mika! Nona! It is
so good to see you!

Mikey moves in for a hug and a giddy Nona goes over for an embrace.

NONA
Oh Mikey, so glad you can help! So
great. How are you! How is
everything!

MIKEY
Oh Non, it could not be better.
Could not be better! Look!

Mikey gestures to BMW and then goes to shake hands with
MIKA

MIKA
You are late. 20 minutes. Late.

MIKEY
Ohhhh, so sorry. So sorry. I had
to take the kids to hockey practice.
It went late. I wanted to call but
I only had your home number and
figured you would already be here.

MIKA
And yet you have coffee.

MIKEY
(Walking with Nona) Yeah, they sell
it at the rink. What did we do
here!

NONA
Don't worry about being late. We
have nothing to do. Look, I cleaned
up the orn of the house.

MIKEY
Oh every littel bit helps Nona.
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)

Every little bit. This, this, this
is a great house. Great house!

MIKA

Yes, good house. Not great though.
But good.

MIKEY

No, no, do not undersell this house.
This (looking at the house) is a
great house.

Mikey makes a gesture with his hand as though taking a
picture.

NONA.

See! I keep telling him it is great
Mikey but he will not listen. He
will not listen.

MIKEY

Don't worry Nona, we'll win him over

(both start laughing)

MIKEY

I already know the price for the
house.

MIKA

What? How the hell do you know the
price for this house. You haven't
step foot in here, in, what 17
years? Again, how the hell do you
know?

MIKEY

Mika. Mika! I know real estate! I
know this stuff. I looked at the
pictures on Google Maps. I know the
exact price. Nona
(looking to Nona) I know the exact
price for this beautiful house, I
know.

NONA

Oh Mikey, I know you do. I know you
do. Come on, let's look at.

MIKA

Why bother? He know price. He
doesn't need to look at anything.
By the way, uh, what exactly is the
price. The pefect price.

Mikey stands. Hands at hip. Taking snapshot pose with hand he looks to Nona.

MIKEY

The price. The price is 320. 320
and not a nickle less.

NONA

Yes!

MIKA

Oh come on!

MIKEY

Absolutely. No doubt! The price is
320 and we can close this baby,
smooth deal, in two weeks.

MIKA

You haven't even looked insided.
Mikey, I am sorry. But you are
crazy if you think you are gonna get
320 for thsi house its - it

MIKEY

Nona. Listen to this guy. Listen
to him!

(slaps Mika on the back a bit too hard)

MIKEY

The house will sell. For 320. I
know real estate. I live and
breathe this stuff. This house will
sell for 320. No doubt.

NONA

I knew it. That will set us up for
something special in Ft. Lauderdale.

MIKA

Its not going to sell for that.
Never going to sell. And even if it
did, we get nothing special in Ft.
Lauderdale for that amount. Sorry.
Nothing.

(looking to Mikey)

Please, set the price lower.

MIKEY

Why go low when you can go high and
get the price you want. The price
you need!

MIKA

Mikey, house is not worth that amount. It should be 240 to 245 at most. At most. Make your life. God, make our life easy. Just start at a reasonable price, sell it fast and get it done.

MIKEY

Why 240 may I ask. Why that price?

MIKA

First, the interior is outdated. All the rooms, all the rooms need renovations. All every last one. Have seen the popcorn ceilings in there.

MIKEY

Ahhhh.... but the house has a good layout. It has a great layout. You can't beat that. And some people like that 70s stuff it is coming back.

MIKA

You haven't been in this friggin house in 17 years. Why don't you walk through. Just imagine you have this mental calculator that figures out renos costs. 10, 20, 30, very quickly you get to 60, 60 thousand in renos to make families who live in this neighborhood happy.

MIKEY

Exactly, its a great neighborhood.

MIKA

Yeah, it is, it is. Have you looked at the comprables. Have you seen houses with this square footage? Look at how good they are on the interior. This is, a joke,

Mikey laughs

MIKEY

Comprables. Nona, you did not tell me that Mika had a side hustle as a real estate agent. You should have told me!

NONA

Oh Mikey, lets go inside and look. The coffee maker is still that. I made coffee and have dansih for you.

MIKA

I am not a fan of danish.

NONA

Mikey is.

Mika turning attention back to Mikey

MIKA

Mikey, I go two blocks that way and find houses with the same amount of space, less traffic, no updates needed, they go for 2-9-9. Why the hell would this go for 340.

MIKEY

You forget about the intangibles.

MIKA

What? What? What intangibles? What, that is on high traffic street with crappy interior. It on Main Street. Mikey, Main Street. Every town has a Main street it is one thing; busy.

MIKEY

Excactly, benefit one. Its on Main Street.

MIKA

So?

MIKEY

Zoned residential

(turns to look at Nona and points to house)

MIKEY

And commerical.

MIKA

So!

MIKEY

You just doubled your market my friend. Doubled it. It could work for a family or professional or doctor or lawyer -

MIKA

Yes, because lawyers are so interested in doing home renovations and not in sending you \$300 invoice for a half hour of work to send you a letter that they will reading date
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
has been set. Yeah, they love
renovations.

NONA
Mika, please listen to Mikey.

MIKA
What?

MIKEY
Mika, Mika, lets look inside the
house. I am going to show how we
are going to get 3-2-0 for this.

(Group headsup driveway. Mikey opens door to house out of
1971.

MIKEY
This house. This house! What a
layout, just as I remembered it.
People are going to love it.

MIKA
Or, or. They might just walk
through this door and this 'This is
a lot of work.'

Mikey disregards comment. Sets coffee down and produces a
camera. As he chats with Nona he then takes one pic. He
next heads to the kitchen and takes one pic, still
chatting with Nona.)

Mika proceeds to walk through the mostly empty house and
peeks into outdated bathrooms and heavily wood paneled
rumpus room with a massive, outdate stereo player.

MIKEY
And whose bedroom was this?

NONA
Stellas. Stella. She had this wall
covered with posters of bands, it
was quite beautiful how she laid it
out. She was always an artist.
Thats why she is Austin now.

MIKEY
Oh Austin, thats a place we might
want to move to! The market there
is so hot.

Mikey againk takes on pic of the room and moves on.

MIKA
One picture.

MIKEY

Hmmm?

MIKA

One pic. Each room you take one pic. Why not take more than that? You know, a selection to choose from.

MIKEY

Again, I am a real estate agent. I know this stuff. One and done!

NONA

They are all signed. All papers are signed. You are our agent Mikey!

Mika, resigned, sitting at the kitchen table.

MIKA

Ok

MIKEY

Hey, where is the pool table? Is it still here? In the basement.

NONA

Yes, its still there! We couldn't sell it during the estate sale. It goes with the house.

MIKEY

Oh, bonus. Hey, I'm going to play a game.

Mikey heads to the basement with Nona.

MIKA

Why not take more pictures.

INT. SCREEN DISPLAYS THREE DAYS LATER. IN MIKA'S HOUSE. AT THE KITCHEN TABLE. MIKA SITS WITH A LAPTOP. NONA CONSTRUCTS SOME TYPE OF COMPLICATED DESSERT.

MIKA

Still no photos. I got to call him. I've got to. Got to.

NONA

Emmmm ... Ok, ok. WE will call him. You are so worried, its annyoing. He will sell the house.

MIKA

I know. I know. He will sell ... just not sure when.

Mikey punches in a number in his cell phone. You hear Mikey's voice.

MIKEY

This is Mikey Derogai - the guy to sell your house.

MIKA

Mikey

MIKEY

Yes.

MIKA

Mikey.

MIKEY

Yes this is he, who is this.

MIKA

Mika. Nona. Its us, the house you are selling.

MIKEY

Oh, Mika, Nona! How are you! Any calls on the house yet, anything?

MIKA

Mikey, why would people be calling us. You are the real estate agent,.

MIKEY

Well sometimes if they know the person selling, they call them and then you have to -

MIKA

Look, no one has called. And really - why would they - there is not single picture of the house.

MIKEY

What?

MIKA

On the site, the site, there's no pictures. None.

MIKEY

What? What?

MIKA

The HOUSE. The Realtors Plus site. There is not one figgin picture of the house. Note one. Three days Mikey.

Nona looks condescendingly. He waves her off and she is back to measuring for a complicated dessert recipe.

NONA
Liters to ounces, what the fuck.

MIKEY
Ohhhhh ohhhhh ... Lemme check.

MIKA
See Mikey, you don't have to check.
I do that for you. There are no pictures.

MIKEY
Ohhhh ... yeah ... this part. Ummm
... give it 10 minutes and check.
The pics look great. Hey, is Nona there?

NONA
Hi Mikey! How many liters to the ounce.

MIKEY
Let me check my phone -

Screen fades to black. Text appears "10 minutes later".
Back in the kitchen. Nona is crouching and looking into an oven.

NONA
Its in. 60 minutes.

MIKA
At least there is no conversion on that, eh?

Mikey pauses. Looks at screen

MIKA
Ok, ok. They are there. And they ...

Pauses

MIKA
Goddamn it. God damn it.

NONA
What? What now!

MIKA
Come. Come. Come look. Witness it.

She turns from the coffee maker as she was making apot.
Mika is smiling.

MIKA
Blurry. All are blurry.

NONA
What?

MIKA
You don't have your friggin readers.
Trust me, every picture is blurry.
Every one. Every. How did he did
he do it. Not one, not two. All!
How.

Nona is back to the coffee.

NONA
Something is wrong with the
computer.

MIKA
Oh yeah, uh-huh. Something is wrong
the computer. Yeah. Ok.

NONA
Ok, something is wrong his camera
then. We need to tell Mikey.
Honestly ...

MIKA
Oh yes, his camera is broken. Sure.
Is broke. Uh-huh

Mika is back to dialing the number.

MIKEY
This is Mikey Derogai. The guy to
sell your house. How can I help
you!

MIKA
By not having blurry pictures.

MIKEY
What, who is this?

MIKA
Mika, Nona. Hello! Pictures are
blurry!

MIKEY
What pictures

MIKA
Of the ghoyuse! The house. All of
the picture, except amazingly of the
basement, are blurry. So if someone
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 is interested in a pool table, dry
 basement and rafters they are going
 to be very happy. Probaby lay out a
 bid on the spot.

From the background Nona reads a magazine at the kitchen
 counter. She shouts.

NONA
 Mikey, something must be wrong with
 your camera!

MIKEY
 Oh hi Nona! Yeah, ok, let me look
 at this.

MIKA
 Why look, you said they looked
 great. Have someone else look. You
 said the pictures looked great.

MIKEY
 Um ... um uh give me five
 minutes.

FADES to black. Overlay text '5 minutes later'. Both
 Nona and Mika sit at kitchen table in silence drinking
 coffee. Nona happily pages through magazine.

NONA
 They are doing a production on
 women's voting rights. That seems
 interesting!

MIKA
 Yeah, what -

Nona's phone rings. She answers and places into speaker
 mode.

MIKEY
 Nona its Mikey, the pictures are not
 good.

MIKA
 That we know. That we are aware of.

MIKEY
 I don't know why. Its that camera.
 That camera. They looked amazing in
 screen on the camera -

MIKA
 Who cares. When can we take more.
 Is nice day, we can do it today or
 tomorrow.

MIKEY

Well, it will have to be Monday.

MIKA

Its frigging Thursday Mikey!
Thursday.

MIKEY

Well, I am not in Aurora.

MIKA

Where the hell are you, Saigon?

MIKEY

No, Cleveland.

MIKA

Cleveland?

NONA

Cleveland! We have many relatives
there Mikey, I can tell you where to
go!

MIKEY

Oh, thanks Nona!

MIKA

Why the hell are you in Cleveland.
Thats like 4 hours away.

MIKEY

Oh, I'm taking the kids to a hockey
tournament. Ryan has a tournament
and I am taking Amber and Fisher
too. It's something!

NONA

Oh, Mikey that sounds like fun!

MIKEY

You would think it would be but you
spend so much time travelling, and
in the hotel, and at the tournament.
But, but the hotel has a pool on
the 12th floor so the kids love
that. And then -

Mika interupts

MIKA

Yes, great, Cleveland. What about
the pictures. When!

MIKEY

Well, Monday. Or maybe today or
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)
tomorrow. I would have to call
someone at the office. I think
maybe Elly could do it. Yeah, that
could work. Do you want me to call
Elly?

MIKA
Mikey, that would is good idea.
That, is an actually good idea.

Nona looks disparagingly and shakes head at him.

MIKEY
Hey Fisher. Stop. STOP. Hey you
have to stop that. Come on, now!
Nona, Mikey, let me - Fisher give it
to him - let me call Elly and then I
will call you.

MIKA
That sounds good.

NONA
Ok, be safe Mikey

MIKEY
Of course! I'll call like in a half
hour. Fisher!

Phone call stops

MIKA
I don't think -

NONA
This guy knows what he is doing.
You keep saying that. The problem
was with the camera. It can be
solved.

Mika pushes away and rises from the table.

MIKA
What the hell kind of names are
those. Ryan, Fisher, Amber. Was it
Amber? Soon, names will be Coyote
and Shooting Star. Native Americans
will say "You have to take that from
us too?"

NONA
Be one thing - one thing - nice.
That child never had a mother.
Never.

MIKA
That child is selling that house.

FADE OUT.

INT. BACK AT COFFEE SHOP. MIKA PICKS UP THE STORY FROM THE SPOT.

MIKA
Bull shit. He did not have a mother when growing up. This, this is true. No mother for many years. But its is not a 'sob story'. This is not Orphan Annie. Mother did not die in child birth. So it is fine.

At this point more retirees have congregated. At least 6 now across two tables. One wears a Viet Nam Vet hat.

FRIEND 2
Annie, she had Daddy Warbucks. That's no sob story either.

FRIEND 3
Warbucks, like was he a defense contractor? Never saw it. But I like the name. Warbucks.

MIKA
Fine. Live in Taumpa.

FRIEND 2
What? Where? Who lives where?

MIKA
Taumpa

FRIEND 3
Are you saying Tampa?

MIKA
Yes, TAUMPA, TAUMPA, TAUMPA BAY! Buccaneers. TAUMPA!

FRIEND 2
What in the hell does that have to do with anything you just said.

MIKA
Let me explain.

FRIEND 3
Tampa is great. Tampa's great! You guys get down there watch the sunset on the Gulf its amazing

VIET NAM VET

I liked riding my bike in Tampa a lot. When I did ride. They have these biker HOV lanes. It was wonderful.

FRIEND 3

What did you ride?

VIET NAM VET

I had a Heritage Softail. It was nice, not too heavy. You always have to be worried about the turns.

MIKA

Yes, yes. Tampa is amazing. Mikey's mother leave Ivan, the father, years ago. Why, not sure. Maybe she was cheating. Maybe she just did not want to be around Ivan ... or Mikey (sips coffee). But she move there with a carpet installer. Remarried to the installer and had two more kids. Maybe come up once or twice year. But not to see Mikey so much, which I have to admit is odd. So, it is true, he have not mother, at least not one that really wanted to see him.

FRIEND 3

Hey, man, that is rough. I mean, I can't. Like, I can't imagine what its like to know your mom is still around. And she has two other kids. But, she sort of could care less about you. I mean, thats gotta do something to you. It cannot be easy. No way.

MIKA

Yes, it did something to him. It made him an absolute moron. Ivan, the father, is not the brightest guy. (sips coffee) The kids was a mess. The milk incident.

FRINED 2

The what incident? Mika, man, its called context man, context. (laughing)

MIKA

The milk incident is perfect example of why something wrong with him. Let me explain.

VIET NAME VET

Please do.

MIKA

We are at church event. Church have a summer picnic. Big event. All families go. So - everyone is there. Many years ago, this is after Nicollette leaves Ivan, summer picnic. Not sure when - 90s sometime because Mikey was probably 6, 7?

Mika sips coffee and then points to friends with index finger.

MIKA

I am sitting at a table. Crappy picnic table.

VIET NAM VET

Why was it crappy? Did you need to swing your legs over? I hate those ones.

FRIEND 3

I think they are all like that? Right?

VIET NAME VET

No, no, some of them have the benches you can pull back.

FRIEND 2

Yeah, but if people are already on the bench you still need to do the swing.

Mika ignores side conversation

MIKA

I am sitting at the table. Mikey comes over and sits across from me. Huge plate of food. And he has a chocolate milk bottle.

FRIEND 2

Like a glass one.

FRIEND 3

Old time glass one. That would be somethin. What kind of picnic is this!

MIKA

No! Not! Milk bottle. Plastic.
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

Plastic. He sits across from. He has trouble with the cap. Its too hard for him to open. So, I am about to offer to open for him when he does this. (Mika mimics Mikey in the following) He take milk bottle. Look at it. Shake it. Stare at ap.

Then, he take bottle and smash it on the table. Like he is smashing the cap to get it off, like its a beer bottle. Bang, bang, bang - hit top hard. Then he stops - and I still remember this - looks at it again and hits and smashes it again.

I say 'Mikey, is screw top. Let me take it off for you.' He look at me and grunt. Not say a word, just grunt. 'You sure you do not want me to help?' He grunt again and then he takes the bottle. Looks at it - and squeezes it. Then, he lifts it above his head

FRIEND 2

By the power of greyskull!

MIKA

He smash as hard as he can. Cap come off. Chocolate milk go everywhere. I am soaked - he is soaked - but not nearly as much. And I say 'That the fuck are you doing! What the fuck!'

There is parent and child in a booth somewhat near.
Parent says.

PARENT

Hey, c'mon, kids. Right here?

MIKA

Sorry, sorry! Important story.
Important.

(Quietly and only to friends)

MIKA

Is Wednesday, 9:30, why are these kids not in school.

(Then loudly again)

MIKA

I say "I tell you cap screws off.
Why did you not le me help!" And he
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 starts bawling. Crying So Ivan
 come over. 'Oh Mikey. Oh Mikey.
 Oh don't cry is all right.' Then to
 me 'Why you make Mikey cry! Why!' I
 say 'Me! He did this! I offered to
 help and take off the cap. All he
 do is grunt and smash stuff.' Then
 other people come over, the mothers
 mostly, and take care of him and a
 couple of them scold me 'He has no
 mother! Be kind Mika, be nice'.

Mika leans back and looks at ceiling.

MIKA
 And that is what happened. Everyone
 'nice' to Mikey. All people are
 nice to Mikey. Mikey is always
 right no matter what. Mikey is
 never wrong.

FRIEND 2
 Friggin carpet installer.

MIKA
 Exactly!

((Note - where is the Janelle scene? With the pictures!))

INT. IN REAL ESTATE OFFICE. AT COFFEE STATION. POT OF
 COFFEE MADE. RUMMAGES THROUGH CUPBOARD AND FINDS PACKET
 OF SWISS MISS. HUGE SMILE. MIXES COFFEE WITH SWISS MISS.
 CO-WORKER COMES IN.

CO-WORKER
 Running a marathon today Mikey?

MIKEY
 Poor man's mocha! But, actually,
 I'm going to do the Aurora 5k this
 year! I start training in a couple
 weeks.

Co-worker raises eyebrow and he secures a cup of coffee.
 Phone rings in cube.

MIKEY
 I gotta get that.

Heads to cube and grabs cell phone.

MIKEY
 This is Mikey Derogai. The guy who
 will sell your house! How can I
 help you today.

CROSS CUTS to Mika and Nona' kithcen. Nona listens and pages through the magazine.

MIKA

First, by putting out number in your contacts. With our name.

MIKEY

Who is this?

MIKA

Its Nona, Mika. You are on speaker.
You texted us to call you at 10AM

MIKEY

Mika, Non! So good to hear from you! I was just thinking about the house.

MIKA

We were thinking too. Any news, offers, anything?

MIKEY

No, no news.

MIKA

Um ... any questions for us? Sort of - whats -

MIKEY

No, no, nothing. But I want to talk about two ideas. Two big ideas!

MIKA

Ok, we are listening. What are the ideas.

MIKEY

First, we need to lower the price. We must lower it.

MIKA

Ok, that I knew. What is the new price.

MIKEY

310. 310. Its a great price.

MIKA

Is still too high. Way too high. Mkae lower please!

MIKEY

No, no, no. It is a perfect price.

MIKA

Ok, why not 300 or 299 or something like that. Why is 310 more perfect than those. And note, those are -

MIKEY

Its a buyers market right now. A buyers market. Yep. In the last month nothing is moving.

MIKA

Ok ... so a buyers market.

MIKEY

YOU know what that means - right?

MIKA

YES! I know what it friggin means, I am not a moron. I know, I know. But Mikey, I do see houses selling that means -

MIKEY

Ok great, so we lower the price. Now, second idea. Open house.

MIKA

YES! Of course, we should have done that weeks ago. Why do you put a house on the market and then not have open house, it makes no sense.

Mikey completely ignores Mika

MIKEY

I want to shoot this Sunday at 1PM. 1PM.

MIKA

Ok so ...

MIKEY

Is it ok with you?

MIKA

YES! Why would it not be ok? Of course.

MIKEY

Well some people get worried about having people going their house, they want to lock up the valuables, worry about stuff being broken.

MIKA

Mikey, house is empty! Remember?
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 Katelyn is dead - she is gone! We
 sold all the stuff. Whatever is
 left, they can steal!

Nona looks up from magazine and shakes head, looks
 disgusted.

MIKA
 Wait, one one seconds

Four seconds pass with focus on Mikey who causally looks
 at picture of his kids at hockey tournament on desk.,

MIKA
 Nona want to be there. I have no
 clue why. She wants to be there.

MIKEY
 Of course! Of course! Yes she can
 be there. Nona - I need some of
 your coffee! Please! Just like you
 made the last time.

NONA
 Don't worry Mikey, I will make it!
 I'll remember to bring cream and
 sugar.

MIKA
 Yes. Cream and sugar. In fact, she
 will bring sweetened condensed
 milk.

MIKEY
 Oh that would be great. Nona, you
 make the best coffee.

MIKA
 Ya, I know. I know. Have known her
 for 32 years, great coffee.

MIKEY
 OK, Nona be there at 12:30, we will
 tidy the house.

NONA
 Ok Mikey, will see you se you then!

MIKEY
 Bye, ciao!

MIKA
 Byte

Phone conversation ends.

MIKA

By tidy, does he mean to tear out
and retile all the bathrooms?
Remove 40 yards of shag carpet.

Smiling, Nona pushes a dessert to MIKA

NONA

Have some dessert. Now in this
article, they explain how the
costumes are selected for the Met
Gala.

Scene goes back to real estate office. Mikey sips the last
of the 'poor mans mocha'

INT. OF NONA AND MIKA HOUSE. DAY OF OPEN HOUSE. MIKA
WANDERS DOWN HALLWAY TO BATHROOM WHERE NONA IS INSIDE
WORKING ON HAIR.

MIKA

Buyers market. My ass buyers
marker. You know Lydia right?
Sevas daughter, yes?

NONA

Of course, yes I know her.

MIKA

I saw her at the supermarket. I
tell her about the house and she,
without me saying anything, just
that we are selling it she says "You
will have no problem - none - it is
a SELLERS market." She just buy a
house one month ago. Some street I
never heard of. Says its a sellers
marker. This guy, he does not know
what he is doing.

NONA

He does! Maybe the market changed?
Maybe when Lydia bought it, it was a
sellers market. And now its not!

Mika waves her off which she can see in the mirror.

MIKA

Bahh, in two months!

MIKA

Explain to me again, why do I need
to go this open house? Please.

NONA

Because I have to go to Irinia's
(MORE)

NONA (CONT'D)

baby shower. Hello. I want to be there to explain things to Mikey about the house when arrives. But I have to go by 1PM.

MIKA

No, I know that, I know when you have to leave. But why can't he just do it. Why do I need to be there at all?

NONA

To help Mikey. To help him if he needs it.

MIKA

What help is he going to need. Irinia, I do not understand why that baby shower is even happening.

NONA

Ok, what do you mean 'Why'. Because it is her first baby, for the first baby you always have a baby shower! You know shower them with gifts, or love, however you wish to see it.

MIKA

But she is not even married. Is she even with this guy?

NONA

Yes, I am going to this baby shower. And yes, she is with 'this guy.' And one final yes, you are going to that open house.

MIKA

But what would I do there? Like be some random guy at a table drinking coffee "Hey! How are you."

Nona sips a smaller expresso cup of coffee.

NONA

I don't want anyone messing with my parent's house. Period.

MIKA

But Mikey is a grown man. A man who can do things. He can ... drive to Cleveland and get his kids asses to a hockey tournament. He can handle an open house.

Nona turns and faces Mika.

NONA

Listen, you are gonna go to that open house. You watch the house. You help Mikey.

MIKA

Fine fine. But I'm not making him a second pot of coffee.

Mika walks down hallway. Makes one last call out.

MIKA

I am going out to the library. I will be at the open house by 1 o'clock. Also, baby shower is for when you are pregnant and married. Pregnant and married.

EXT. OF NONA'S PARENT'S HOUSE. JUST MIKA'S CAR IS IN THE DRIVEWAY. MULTIPLE CARS WHIZ BY. AS MIKA WALKS UP DRIVEWAY A FAT BLACK CAT HUSSLES OUT OF GARAGE AND DOWN DRIVEWAY. HISSES AT MIKA. HE WALKS INSIDE.

NONA

Oh Mika, Mikey was just telling me a terrific story about Amber and the kids and how they got locked out of the house on Black Friday.

MIKEY

Yes, they went out early and -

MIKA

Yes, I'm sure its a great story. How is the open house? How many people have stopped to look?

MIKEY

None, yet. Officially it hasn't started.

MIKA

Ok, if people are interested wouldn't they be here already? Yes? Like to be the first ones to see it in person.

Nona ignoring Mikey.

NONA

I have to go Mikey. Good luck! Irninia's baby shower.

MIKEY

Ohhhh, she is having a shower. That is beautiful! Good for her.

NONA

I know, I know, she is so luck.

MIKA

Yes, beautiful thing. Beautifyul thing. Nona, we need to before you go.

NONA

Ya, ya, ok, BYE MIKEY.

MIKEY

Ok, by Nona, And hey (as though telling a secret) I won't tell Amber you ake the best coffee around.

NONA

Mikey!

Mika hustle here down the hallway leading out

MIKA

I just thought something. Something we need to talk about. The gift.

NONA

What gift. What do you mean,

MIKA

Irinia, Irinia. Gifr. How much to give. Now diner or brunch at Heffingers. Can cost no more that \$15 dollars a plate. No more. I looked online at the catering menu.

NONA

Oh come on.

MIKA

Gift should be no more that \$50.

Nona laughs.

NONA

You are crazy. You are nuts. No one gives \$50 for a baby shower! A \$100, at least. Probably more. If you give \$50, you are cheap bastard. Besides, for a baby shower you give a gift.

MIKA

How much did you spend. Mind you, she is not even -

NONA
 Married. I know. Mmmm. Let me
 think. Baby swing, embroidered bids,
 at least \$200.

MIKA
 What!

NONA
 At least \$200. Maybe more.

MIKA
 You can't give her that much.
 That's crazy!

NONA
 Well I did. You stay, watch house,
 help Mikey.

MIKA
 What, drink coffee?

NONA
 Help Mikey.

Mika heads to kitchen. Pours cup of coffee and sits with
 Mikey.

MIKEY
 Cream?

10 minutes later, Mikey is droning on.

MIKEY
 Mika, you would not believe it. You
 would not believe this goal.

MIKA
 Yes, you must be there to
 appreciate.

MIKEY
 He, he just from around the back of
 the net, he takes the puck one way,
 goes the other then and bang,
 backhands it in. Oh man, just
 beautiful. The team calls that play
 the Monte Cristo because it's so
 good. It's that good.

MIKA
 Yes, wonderful. Fishes must be very
 talented.

MIKEY
 Oh you have no idea. Look at this -

Door opens. A young couple with a child enters the house.

MIKEY

Welcome, welcome! So glad to have you here to see this house. I am Mikey. Who do I have the pleasure of seeing here today!

SARAH

Sarah

JOHN

John. And this is our son

Mika is in the kitchen. Eyes close and listening

John
Atticus.

Mika nods and smiles.

MIKEY

Hey little guy! You want to see the house! Come on - come on in! This house was built for kids! It was build in 68. Well, you probably know the specs, but what's best about this house. The layout and flow. Just give it a look! If you have any questions, just give a holler!

The couple wanders around and looks at stuff in a grossly outdated living room. There is a massive white brick fireplace with smoke stains about the outside of it. The husband looks at the bookshelf adjoining it. Mikey appears behind him.

MIKEY

How far along are you on the journey.

JOHN

Excuse me. Journey?

MIKEY

The house hunting journey. That journey!

JOHN

Oh, oh. Just starting. In fact we just happened to be driving by and decided to give it a look. Its seemed nice. We liked the brick exterior.

MIKEY

Exactly. Its like a strawberry red,
its very nice. Oh, all the books
and all the items are still for
sale. Just make an offer if you are
intereted!

John peruses a book

JOHN

Uh, my cyrillic is a real suty.
Don't think a cyrillic dictionary
will do me much good.

Sarah goes out back with child. Mikey immediately foolws.

MIKEY

Now this, this is a great yard.
Great yard. Perfect for the summer
and hosting parties.

SARAH

Um, yeah, its ok.

MIKEY

What do you moean ok? All the
fences are there, its private.
Hosting!

SARAH

Well, its really narrow. And, uh,
there is no deck. Just a big
concrete slab. Which is ...
interesting. Honey, don't fall on
that.

MIKEY

Ya know, a more confined backyard is
actually better. You want it to
fell cozy. Your guests will mingle
better.

SARAH

Um, yeah, I enver thought of it like
that. Never thought like that.

MIKEY

Come on, let's take a look at the
dining room. Hey, Atticus, where
does the bounce house go!

ATTICUS

Oh, we own one of those! We own our
own! Its so fun!

SARAH

Not next to the concrete slab.
Those things tip.

All enter the house. Sarah and child decidedly do not go to the dining room. Mikey enters it to find John staring at the chandelier.

MIKEY

Ahhh, you like it? That is high end, high end chandelier. Top of the line.

JOHN

I was actually thinking its was kind of ugly. I mean, this is right out of 1972. You can see, they were going for like a French provincial look but is all wrong.

MIKEY

No, no. Top of the line. This stuff is coming back, big! It is big right now. You go to a vintage shop and that same chandelier, you are looking at at least 600 or 800.